

NATHALIE GUESSELE

SQL Server Database Administrator

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High Availability | Performance Tuning | Disaster Recovery | Data Migration | Replication | Always-On | Azure |
SSIS | Security & Compliance | VLDB | Query Optimization | DB Design | Monitoring & Alerts.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven and highly analytical SQL Server Database Administrator with **6+ years of experience managing 300+ production databases across 30+ instances**, ensuring **99.9% uptime** and robust disaster recovery. Skilled in **SQL Server 2008–2022, Azure SQL, and cloud database migrations**. Proven expertise in **performance tuning (50% CPU reduction, 40% faster queries)**, **high availability (Always On, Replication, Log Shipping, Clustering)**, and **security compliance (TDE, DDM, RBAC, MFA)**. Basic knowledge of **cybersecurity principles, RMF, and ISSO support functions**, ensuring secure database administration practices. Experienced with **virtualization (Hyper-V, VMware)**, **ETL pipelines (SSIS)**, and **automation with PowerShell and T-SQL**.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- SQL Server Installation, Configuration, and Upgrades (2008–2022)
- Always On Availability Groups, Log Shipping, Replication, Clustering
- Performance Tuning & Query Optimization (Execution Plans, Indexing, Statistics)
- Backup, Restore & Disaster Recovery (RPO/RTO Compliance)
- SSIS / SSRS / ETL Development
- Azure SQL / Cloud Migrations
- Security & Compliance: TDE, Always Encrypted, DDM, RBAC, MFA, AD Integration
- Cybersecurity Awareness | Risk Management Framework (RMF) | ISSO Support
- Virtualization (VMware, Hyper-V) | Windows Server Administration
- PowerShell / T-SQL Scripting | Automation & Alerting
- Incident & Change Management | Cross-Functional Collaboration

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

SSMS, Azure, Git, SSIS, PowerShell, Visual Studio, Jira, OneNote, Redgate Tools, Active Directory, SQL Profiler, Extended Events, Performance Monitor, ServiceNow, Query Store, SolarWinds, SSRS, Cisam, Xacta, VMware, Hyper-V

EDUCATION & TRAININGS

- **Bachelor of Arts in Accounting and Finance** – University of SOA | Dec 2015
- **Advanced Database Administration, T-SQL Programming & Cloud Technologies Training**

Certifications

- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate**
- **Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SQL Server Database Administrator

Community Support Services – Rockville, MD | Oct 2021 – Present

- Administered **100+ production/development databases**, configured **Always On & Log Shipping**, and automated backups with PowerShell/SQL Agent → ensured **99.9% uptime** and reduced manual tasks by **40%**.
- Tuned queries, indexes, and execution plans → delivered **50% CPU reduction** and **40% faster report response times**.
- Hardened environments with **group policy, secure service accounts, RBAC, TDE, Always Encrypted, DDM, AD integration** → reduced vulnerability exposure by **35%**.
- Migrated on-prem workloads to **AWS RDS/EC2** and provisioned **Azure HA/DR solutions** → cut costs by **30%** while improving resilience.
- Conducted **bi-annual failover/DR testing** and aligned procedures with RPO/RTO → validated full recovery readiness.
- Developed **automated SQL alerting systems** using Database Mail & SQL Agent → improved incident response time by **25%**.
- Maintained hybrid (on-prem + Azure) environments via **DBCC CHECKDB, DMVs, proactive monitoring** → safeguarded data integrity.
- Applied **Windows & SQL patches** in VMware/Hyper-V environments → ensured compliance and improved system performance.
- Partnered with developers on **query tuning & schema optimization** → improved transactional efficiency across core applications.
- Documented DBA processes and SOPs → supported team knowledge sharing and reduced onboarding time for new staff.

Database Administrator

Yvickland & Associates LLC – Washington, D.C. | Feb 2017 – Sep 2021

- Managed **1,500+ databases across 200 servers** in clustered/virtualized environments (VMware/Hyper-V) → ensured SLA compliance for **20+ clients**.
- Upgraded from SQL 2012 → 2019 with zero downtime → improved reliability and reduced maintenance costs by **30%**.
- Strengthened security with **MFA, RBAC, Always Encrypted, audit specs with alerts** → enhanced incident response posture.
- Developed **SSIS ETL packages** and Power BI dashboards → cut data transfer lag by **25%** and improved reporting efficiency.
- Built **custom alerting and maintenance scripts** via T-SQL/SQL Agent → improved monitoring and reduced response times.
- Served as **escalation point for DR incidents** and delivered **knowledge transfer sessions** to junior DBAs → improved cross-team efficiency.
- Upgraded **SQL Server 2008 → 2016** using in-place and side-by-side strategies → ensured application continuity for mission-critical systems.
- Deployed **Always On Availability Groups in a 3-node cluster (2 on-prem, 1 DR site)** → achieved seamless failover and ensured business continuity.

KEY ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- **Reduced CPU usage by 50% and improved query response time by 40%** through advanced query tuning and indexing strategies.
- **Cut infrastructure costs by 30%** by leading large-scale database migrations to **AWS RDS/EC2** and deploying **Azure HA/DR solutions**.
- **Strengthened security compliance** by implementing **MFA, RBAC, TDE, Always Encrypted, and DDM**, reducing vulnerabilities by **35%**.
- **Ensured 99.9% uptime across 300+ production databases** by implementing **Always On Availability Groups, Log Shipping, and automated backup/maintenance solutions**.